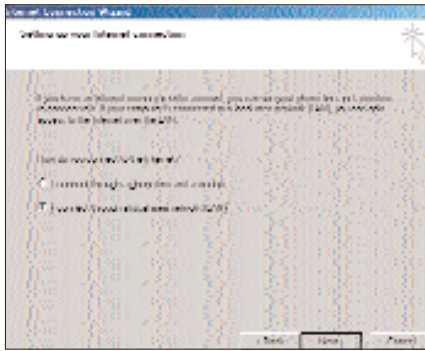




The right way to connect to the Internet

ing the configuration of computers that use TCP/IP. You should now be able to share the Internet connection using one connection.

Hardware

+ Get connected

I have two computers, one a Celeron 600 and the other a Pentium 4. Can you suggest a way to connect them via modem without using the phone line? Both the computers have an internal modem.

Sandeep

Via e-mail

R You can use a null telephone cable to connect the two modems and use a shell emulation program such as HyperTerminal to make a call from the first machine and manually pick it up on the other one by passing a command, as there is no ring tone involved to make your other modem aware that somebody is trying to connect.

Hardware

+ Modem woes

My modem is installed on the COM4 and mouse on COM2 port. When I click on the modem icon in the task bar and go to the 'com ports' option, my mouse becomes inactive, but everything else works properly. I am forced to restart my PC using [Ctrl] + [Esc] and things work fine until I click on the modem icon. The Device Manager in my control panel shows that there are no conflicting device listings in the resources menu. My COM1 port is of 25 pins and I have a 25 to 9 pin converter on which, if I connect my mouse, there is no such problem. I've even tried installing the modem on different slots such as PCI-3 and PCI-4 but I get the same result.

I have tried installing Creative Infra Suite, but as soon as the Creative Infra icon appears in the task bar at start up, my mouse stops working. I have also tried interchanging the COM port cable on the motherboard, but it's the same story.

Viren Chavan

Via e-mail

R We would strongly advise you to remove your internal modem and check it on some other PC. If you have the same problem in the other PC, then obviously it is the modem that is faulty. However, if it works fine, and if you are using a mouse which fits only in a serial port, make sure it is installed on the COM2 port of your machine. We would recommend you to go in for a new PS/2 mouse, which will also save up on IRQs.

Hardware

+ Grappling with graphics

I have a P-4 1.5 GHz system with 256 MB of RDRAM. I have a Riva TNT2 graphics card, which I recently replaced with a similar card from a different manufacturer. After changing the card I got an error message: "emm386 not installed. Unable to set frame base page address. Press any key when ready." A little later, without pressing a key, the following message appears: "Expanded memory service not available. emm386 successfully installed. Total upper memory available 66k largest memory block 54k. Starting base page address d100hemm386 active." I have reinstalled everything including the OS, but all in vain. I am using Win 98 Second Edition after quick reformatting. I have also made changes in system.ini and start up, but that was also of no use.

Ashish Gaba

Via e-mail

R We would recommend that you first uninstall your previous graphics card drivers. In the Add/Remove option in the Control Panel, select the previous graphics card driver and uninstall it. Then reinstall the

newer drivers, which will be available on the manufacturer's Web site or on the diskette that came along with the graphics card.

If this does not work then format your machine and reinstall the operating system. However, if the error still occurs then it is very likely that your RAM module is faulty.

Windows

+ BIOS hazards

I recently tried to update my BIOS as it does not support a 40 GB hard disk drive. I obtained the update from the manufacturer's Web site. I used awdfash.exe (ver8.08) to flash the BIOS. Every time I chose to backup the old BIOS the computer just did nothing (i.e. no hard disk activity for the next 15 minutes). Then I tried to flash my BIOS without a backup. It gave me a warning: 'part no in BIOS and the file do not match'. I ignored the message and continued with flashing. Now after the so-called update, the computer won't boot, that is, I hear no beep at start up. The hard disk drive light keeps glowing and nothing happens. Also, the monitor light keeps blinking (indicating that it's idle). How do I go back to the previous BIOS? Can I remove the chip and reprogram it?

Pratik Soares

Via e-mail

R It seems you have not updated your BIOS in the right manner and as a result it is likely that you have damaged your BIOS by not heeding to the warning given by the flash program.

You can ask for a similar BIOS chip from your vendor by giving the right model name to your vendor.

Hardware

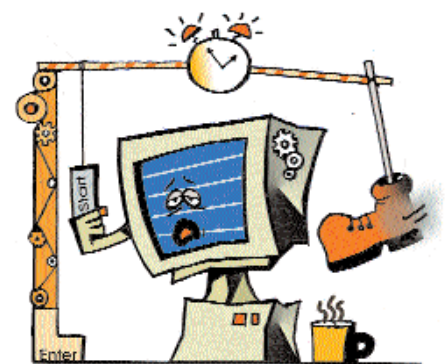
Hanging errors

I have a branded PC at my home. I am satisfied with the performance of the system. But occasionally, while booting, the system hangs and I am unable to do anything else. The entire screen fills up with lots of small horizontal white lines against the usual blue background of the bootup screen. I have to switch off the power supply to the PC and switch it on once again. I cannot even take a snapshot of the screen because the PC has not yet booted up and I can't start any program. How do I fix this problem?

Gunniboy

Via e-mail

R It seems your RAM module is faulty. Try changing the RAM and see if the



Illustrations: Farzana Cooper

problem still occurs. If the problem persists even after changing the RAM, then it is very likely that the RAM on your video card (VRAM) is faulty. You should try using a different video card. This should solve your problem.